

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

CASTE ASPERSIONS

Amid the clamour for a caste census, Opposition leaders are attacking Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**'s OBC credentials. On November 4, Janata Dal (United) national president Rajiv Ranjan alias Lalan Singh called Modi a fraud saying he is not an OBC. The same day, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi asked why Modi identifies as OBC when he considers 'poor' the only caste in the country. Earlier, in October, Bihar chief minister Nitish Kumar claimed Modi allegedly got his caste–the Modh-Ganchi– included in the OBC list in 2002 when he was Gujarat CM. It was the social welfare department of the then Congress state government, though, that had passed a notification in July 1994, announcing 36 castes, including Modh-Ghanchis, as OBC.

It Just Ain't Cricket



More than 500 people turned up for a special screening of the India vs South Africa match that West Bengal governor **C.V. Ananda Bose** hosted at the Raj Bhawan. There was no doubting the political colour of the meeting. Bose announced a Governor's Century group, under which 100 children with a talent for cricket will be trained and nurtured, and also heaped praises on the BCCI and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, calling India's win against South Africa a sign of Aatmanirbhar Bharat. Needless to say, the ruling Trinamool Congress wasn't too happy, calling Bose a stooge of the Centre again and accusing him of running a parallel administration. Expect another governor-state government conflict.

AAPside Down



AAP MLAs are getting caught in legal troubles, and not just in New Delhi. Now, the party's tribal face in Gujarat—**Chaitar Vasava**—has been charged with firing in the air during a showdown between tribals and forest department officials, who claim that tribals were irrigating forest land. AAP has thrown its weight behind its MLA, whose popularity has risen so much that state AAP president Isudan Gadhvi announced Vasava might contest the Lok Sabha polls. Right now, the young MLA is on the run and his wife under arrest.

Kaushik Deka with Avishek Ghosh Dastidar, Jumana Shah, Amarnath K. Menon, Arkamoy Datta Majumdar

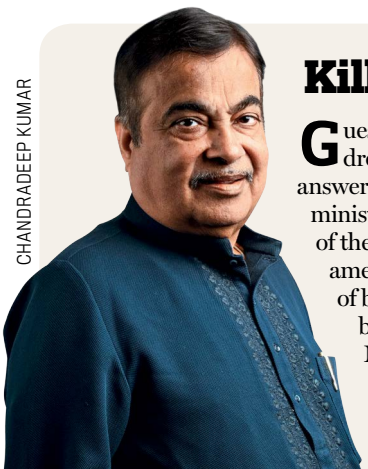
LETTER THAT ISN'T?

For long building a Hyderabad vs Bengaluru narrative, BRS working president **K.T. Rama Rao** (KTR) has dialled up the volume closer to the state polls on November 8. Alleging a Congress conspiracy to shift industry to Bengaluru to bleed Telangana, KTR says Karnataka deputy CM **D.K. Shivakumar** wrote to Taiwan-based Foxconn Technology, which is setting up an





Apple Air Pod unit in Hyderabad, to consider relocation. Dismissing the letter as fake, Shivakumar has complained to the cyber cops. Trouble is, the letter's already gone viral.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

Killing Two Birds

Guess who's sharing his 'mann ki baat' with schoolchildren now. On November 4, at a function in Nagpur, while answering a question on the role of women in politics, Union minister **Nitin Gadkari** said, "No person is superior because of their caste, creed, language or gender.... Indira Gandhi became prime minister without any reservation. In this 'game of backwardness', everyone wants to prove that they are backward." Now that's a dual dig. It's the Narendra Modi-led central government that passed the Women's Reservation Bill, and Opposition parties are demanding a caste census and higher reservations.